to consciousness: 'If blue is perceived, then how can it be called external? And if it is not perceived, how can it be called external?' Moreover, since blue and the awareness of blue always occur together, they are not different (***sahopalambha-niyama***).

If physical objects external to the mind existed, they would be either enduring whole entities or temporary configurations of atoms. The Buddhist ***Vaibhashika*** realists claimed that we directly perceive physical objects that are composed of atoms. An atom is partless and indivisible. But if atoms come together they will have sides (a type of part). If they coalesce, there will be no increase in extent. If they have no dimension, they cannot combine to form larger objects. If they have dimension, they will be divisible. Idealist Buddhists reject the notion of the integral whole (***avayavin***) over and above its parts because we do not cognise a single substance, itself consisting of no parts, apart from a collection of parts. If this is problematic, so much more so is that of categories such as universal property, the inherence relation, quality-particular, and substance which are applied to them by the ***Nyaya-Vaisheshikas***.

Sautrantikas say that we cannot know momentary reality but only our representations of it, on the basis of which we infer the existence of mind-independent reality. The *Vijnanavadins* respond that we do not need to infer an objective reality as the casual basis of our experience, which is intelligible simply in terms of a beginningless stock of impressions left by previous ideas.

Awareness occurs in dreams and hallucinations without any external objects lending it causal support (***alambana***). It may be argued that the organised nature of waking awareness implies that we know objects at particular times and places. Moreover, much experience is shared by many and is not private. ***Vasubandhu*** responds that